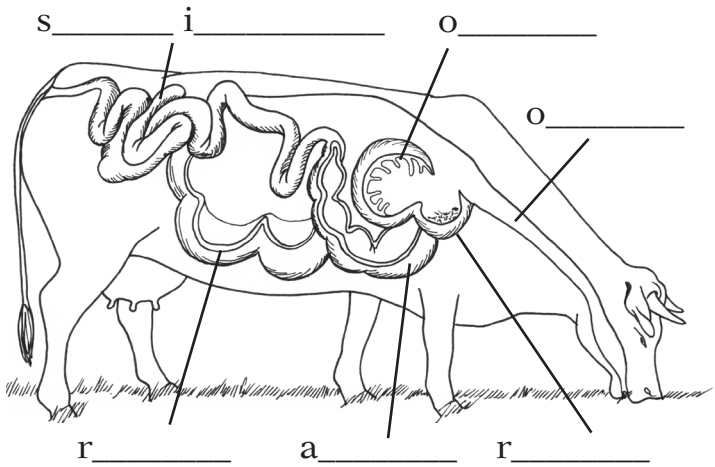
Human vs cow digestion

Human digestive systems are called **monogastric** systems. A cow's digestive system is called a **ruminant** system. Ruminants have four stomachs, beginning with the rumen, then the reticulum, the omasum and finally the abomasum. Chewed grass stored in the rumen is regurgitated back into the mouth and the cow chews it again. This is called chewing the cud. The cud is then swallowed and passes to the reticulum.

☞ **1** Use the word bank to label the diagram of the cow's digestive system.



ruminant system

Word bank

oesophagus
small intestine
rumen
reticulum
abomasum
omasum

2 Can you list two other animals that 'chew the cud'? _____

3 Why do ruminants 'chew the cud'? _____

_____

4 If humans ate grass, what would happen to the grass during digestion? _____

_____

5 Label these statements true or false.

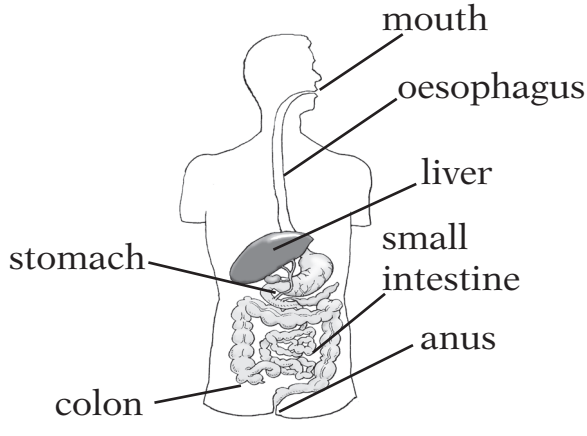
a) Cows chew the cud. _____

b) Cows have three stomachs. _____

c) The rumen is the third stomach. _____

d) Humans only have one stomach. _____

e) Both cows and humans have an intestine. _____



monogastric system

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